MAHIR AFSER PAVEL

AI Researcher | Medical AI · Multimodal Learning · Efficient and Reliable Deep Learning

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Google Scholar · ORCID · ResearchGate · GitHub · LinkedIn · Portfolio

Profile Summary

AI researcher specializing in **medical image analysis**, with an emphasis on developing computationally efficient, reliable, and interpretable AI methods. Research spans knowledge distillation, explainable AI, vision-language models, quantization, federated learning, and visual question answering. **First author** of articles in Scientific Reports and PLOS One; **co-first author** of an article in the International Journal of Dentistry; second author of articles in Drones and Vehicles; and third author of an article in IEEE Access. Google Scholar profile: **100+ citations, h-index: 3,** and **i10-index: 2,** verified (November 2026).

Research Interests

- **Medical Image Analysis and Clinical AI:** Medical image classification and segmentation, disease detection, and AI-assisted clinical triage.
- **Multimodal Learning and Foundation Models:** Vision-language models (VLMs), medical image-text alignment, and visual question answering (VQA).
- **Efficient and Explainable AI:** Knowledge distillation, model compression and quantization, explainable AI (XAI), and computationally efficient deep learning.
- **Clinical Natural Language Processing and Privacy-Preserving AI:** Federated learning, generative augmentation, clinical text analysis, robustness, and interpretable AI

Education

North South University—Dhaka, Bangladesh
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Engineering | 2019–2023

- **CGPA: 3.71/4.00** [*Grading Policy*]
- ***CSE-specific GPA: 3.91****/4.00 (Capstone Design, Core, and Elective Courses)*
- ***Class Rank: 38th*** *out of 595 students*

B.Sc. Thesis: *"Non-small cell lung cancer detection through knowledge distillation approach with teaching assistant"*

- **Supervisor:** Dr. Riasat Khan (Associate Professor, Department of ECE). *[Link]*
- **Summary:** Implemented a three-stage knowledge distillation architecture for lung cancer classification on the *NSCLC-Radiomics* dataset, achieving 94.53% accuracy, and later deployed it in a user-friendly web application.

Scholarly Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Publications

- ***Multi-stage knowledge distillation with layer fusion-based deep learning approach for skin cancer classification***.
  - ✔ ***Authors: Mahir Afser Pavel****, Ramisa Asad, Goh Kah Ong Michael, Md Ikramuzzaman, Murad Mustakim, and Riasat Khan.*
  - ✔ ***Venue****: Scientific Reports (Nature Portfolio), 2025. DOI: 10.1038/s41598-025-23403-2 [Code]*
- ***Non-small cell lung cancer detection through knowledge distillation approach with teaching assistant***
  - ✔ ***Authors: Mahir Afser Pavel****, Rafiul Islam, Shoyeb Bin Babor, Riaz Mehadi, and Riasat Khan*
  - ✔ ***Venue****: PLOS One (PLOS), 2024. DOI: 10.1371/journal.pone.0306441 [Code]*
- ***Error-Tolerant Multimodal Vision-Language Models for Endodontic Triaging: A Cross-Sectional Study***.
  - ✔ ***Authors: Mahir Afser Pavel*** *(Co-First Author), Md Fahim Shahoriar Titu (Co-First Author), Afifa Zain Apurba, Saif Ahmed, Shafin Rahman, James Dudley, and Taseef Hasan Farook*
  - ✔ ***Venue****: International Journal of Dentistry (Wiley), 2026. DOI: 10.1155/ijod/4148741. [Code]*
- ***Fusion of Image Filtering and Knowledge-Distilled YOLO Models for Root Canal Failure Diagnosis***
  - ✔ ***Authors:*** *Afifa Zain Apurba, Md Fahim Shahoriar Titu,* ***Mahir Afser Pavel****, Intisar Tahmid Naheen, and Riasat Khan*
  - ✔ ***Venue:*** *IEEE Access (IEEE), 2025. DOI: 10.1109/ACCESS.2025.3560998. [Code]*
- ***Real-time fire detection: Integrating lightweight deep learning models on drones with edge computing***
  - ✔ ***Authors:*** *Md Fahim Shahoriar Titu,* ***Mahir Afser Pavel****, Goh Kah Ong Michael, Hisham Babar, Umama Aman, and Riasat Khan.*
  - ✔ ***Venue****: Drones (MDPI), 2024. DOI: 10.3390/drones8090483 [Code]*
- ***Hybrid ViT-RetinaNet with Explainable Ensemble Learning for Fine-Grained Vehicle Damage Classification***
  - ✔ ***Authors****: Ananya Saha,* ***Mahir Afser Pavel****, Md Fahim Shahoriar Titu, Afifa Zain Apurba, and Riasat Khan.*
  - ✔ ***Venue:*** *Vehicles (MDPI), 2025. DOI: 10.3390/vehicles7030089. [Code]*

Manuscripts Under Review

- ***Federated Multi-Component Framework for Brain Tumor Diagnosis with Generative Augmentation and Explainable AI***
  - ***Authors: Mahir Afser Pavel****, Nafiz Fahad, Md Tanzib Hosain, Md. Kishor Morol, and Tze Hui Liew*
  - ***Status:*** *Under Review at Array (Elsevier), 2026*
- ***CLKD-MED: A novel cross-lingual knowledge distillation framework for multilingual clinical outcome prediction***
  - ***Authors: Mahir Afser Pavel****, Rafiul Islam, Mohammad Junayed Hasan, and M. R. C. Mahdy*
  - ***Status:*** *Under Review at Information Processing & Management (Elsevier), 2026*

- ***SLGRA-Net: Structure-Aware Latent Graph Reasoning for 3D Brain Tumor Segmentation***
  - ***Authors: Mahir Afser Pavel****, Nafiz Fahad, Md Tanzib Hosain, Md. Kishor Morol, and Tze Hui Liew*
  - ***Status:*** *Under Review at Biomedical Signal Processing and Control (Elsevier), 2026*

Research in Progress

- ***Trustworthy Clinical AI for Diabetic Retinopathy Grading via Hybrid Foundation Models, Calibration-Aware Uncertainty Learning, and Multi-Criteria Clinical Referral***
- ***S³-Net: Self-Stabilizing, Self-Regulating, and Self-Optimizing Neural Networks via Universal Stability Learning***
- ***FULCRUM: Option-Contrastive Frame Selection for Long-Video Understanding***
- ***ACP-KD: Adaptive Clinical Prototype Knowledge Distillation with Dynamic Feature Fusion and Confidence-Aware Multi-Objective Learning for Lightweight Skin Lesion Classification***

Professional Experience

Research Assistant | ELITE Research Lab LLC (Dhaka, Bangladesh) (Aug 2025 – Present)

- **Federated Brain Tumor Classification:** Developed *Fed-GAN-DE-CL*, a federated multi-component framework that integrates generative adversarial networks and dual-encoder contrastive learning for decentralized brain tumor classification without centralizing patient data.
- **3D Brain Tumor Segmentation:** Proposed *SLGRA-Net*, incorporating structure-aware latent graph reasoning to model spatial relationships and address ambiguous tumor boundaries in 3D MRI segmentation.
- **Ongoing Research:** Contributing to research on trustworthy clinical AI, self-optimizing neural networks, and adaptive knowledge distillation, focusing on uncertainty calibration, neural network stability, and lightweight skin lesion classification.

Research Assistant | United International University (Dhaka, Bangladesh) (May 2025 – Jun 2025)

- **Research and Development:** Optimized transformer architectures and developed multilingual benchmarks for low-resource languages using Hugging Face Transformers and PyTorch Lightning, leveraging TensorBoard and Weights & Biases (W&B) for experiment tracking, visualization, and hyperparameter tuning. Designed and implemented data preprocessing, feature engineering, and model-training pipelines. Conducted literature reviews on emerging multi-agent systems, identified research opportunities, and contributed to research proposal development.

Research Assistant | North South University (Dhaka, Bangladesh) (May 2024 – Jul 2024)

- **Edge AI and Real-Time Fire Detection:** Co-developed a drone-based fire detection pipeline using knowledge distillation to deploy lightweight YOLOv8n models on Raspberry Pi 5 devices for edge inference.

Research Trainee | Mahdy Research Academy (Remote / Online) (Jan 2024 – Mar 2025)

- **Cross-Lingual Clinical NLP:** Introduced *CLKD-MED***,** a knowledge distillation framework for multilingual clinical outcome prediction using 92,293 clinical notes from the MIMIC-III dataset, transferring clinical representations across English and lower-resource languages to predict length of stay and mortality.

Academic Projects & Research Focus

- **Medical Image Analysis, Knowledge Distillation & Explainable AI:** Developing knowledge distillation, layer-fusion, and lightweight deep learning methods for medical image classification and diagnosis, including skin lesion classification, non-small cell lung cancer detection from CT scans, dental radiograph analysis, and brain tumor analysis. Applying SHAP, LIME, and Score-CAM to interpret model predictions.
- **Medical Vision-Language Models & Efficient Clinical AI:** Evaluating multimodal vision-language models, including BLIP, CLIP, Florence-2, and PaliGemma, for dental triage and medical image understanding. Exploring quantization-aware training, model compression, and efficient adaptation to reduce computational and memory requirements while preserving diagnostic performance.
- **Dental Image Analysis & Knowledge Distilled Object Detection:** Developing image-processing and knowledge distillation pipelines for automated root canal failure diagnosis using dental radiographs. Integrating Grounded SAM-assisted annotation with YOLO-based detection and teacher-student modeling.
- **Computer Vision, Explainable Detection & Edge Deployment:** Designing computer vision systems for real-world recognition, including YOLO-based fire detection on drones and Raspberry Pi 5 hardware, and Hybrid ViT–RetinaNet with Weighted Box Fusion for vehicle damage classification.
- **Federated Learning, Generative Augmentation & Biomedical AI:** Investigating federated learning, generative adversarial networks, and synthetic data augmentation for brain tumor diagnosis across decentralized, non-IID data distributions. Exploring structure-aware graph reasoning, latent feature representations, and 3D volumetric segmentation, alongside explainability and reliability-aware evaluation to address data heterogeneity and improve robustness in collaborative biomedical learning.
- **Clinical NLP, Cross-Lingual Learning & Medical Language Models:** Investigating cross-lingual knowledge distillation for multilingual clinical outcome prediction, particularly in low-resource languages. Exploring medical language models and retrieval-augmented generation for clinical reasoning, multimodal medical question answering, and healthcare decision support.
- **Reliable Clinical AI & Uncertainty-Aware Prediction:** Investigating calibration-aware uncertainty estimation, confidence-aware learning, and clinical referral strategies for diabetic retinopathy grading and related medical classification tasks. Evaluating reliability through calibration, robustness, and the relationship between model confidence and diagnostic correctness.
- **Adaptive Learning & Generalizable AI:** Exploring adaptive clinical prototype knowledge distillation, dynamic feature fusion, and confidence-aware multi-objective optimization for lightweight skin lesion classification. Broader interests include stability-oriented learning architectures and efficient video understanding.

Teaching, Research & Academic Leadership

- **Research Leadership and Team Coordination (2023–2024):** Led research initiatives in deep learning, computer vision, and clinical NLP at ELITE Research Lab LLC and Mahdy Research Academy. Coordinated research assistants and senior design projects at North South University, mentoring junior students and supporting data-pipeline development and manuscript preparation across projects associated with five peer-reviewed journal articles.
- **Academic Manuscript Peer Reviewer (2026):** Reviewed research manuscripts for IEEE and Elsevier journals, evaluating methodological rigor, technical validity, originality, and clarity.
- **Teaching and Student Mentoring (2022–2023):** Co-led academic sessions and supported laboratory instruction in Digital Electronics, Analog Electronics, and Senior Design at North South University under faculty supervision. Mentored students in circuit mapping, hardware–software co-design, laboratory troubleshooting, and scientific writing.

Technical & Research Skills

Category	Tools and Technologies
Programming Languages	Python (Advanced), C++, Java, Bash
AI/ML Frameworks	PyTorch, TensorFlow, Keras, Scikit-learn, OpenCV
Generative AI & VLMs	LangChain, LLaMA, RAG, LoRA, QAT, BLIP, CLIP, Florence-2, PaliGemma
Research & Development Tools	Git, GitHub, LaTeX, Overleaf
Databases & Analysis	SQL, MySQL, NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib, SPSS, Microsoft Excel

Standardized Examination Scores

IELTS Academic (2026): Overall: 6.5 | Listening: 7.0 | Reading: 7.0 | Writing: 6.5 | Speaking: 6.0

Honors & Awards

- **Magna Cum Laude (December 2024):** Awarded by North South University for academic excellence in the B.Sc. in Computer Science and Engineering program; ranked within the top 7% of the cohort.
- **Academic Merit Scholarships:** Received multiple tuition waivers of 10%–20% from North South University based on semester academic performance, with semester GPAs reaching 4.00.
- **Peer Reviewer Recognition (2026):** Recognized for peer-review contributions to IEEE Access, Heliyon, and Frontiers in Computer Science.

References

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